

D380

Email Marketing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fitness chain buys a list of 50,000 local email addresses from a data broker to promote a new gym. The list cost \$2,000 and includes zip codes. Under permission-based email practice, what is the core problem?

- A. Four cents per address is too expensive.
- B. The recipients never opted in to hear from the gym, which breaks permission-based practice and hurts deliverability.
- C. US law makes it illegal everywhere to email anyone who has not opted in.
- D. Nothing is wrong as long as each email has an unsubscribe link.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under US CAN-SPAM, a subscriber clicks “unsubscribe” on a promotional email. How soon must the sender honor it?

- A. Within 30 days
- B. Not required if the subscriber is already a customer
- C. Within 10 business days
- D. Within one hour, or the sender is automatically fined

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A retailer’s list of 80,000 includes 9,000 addresses that hard-bounced last month and 20,000 with no opens in 18 months. Inbox placement is falling. The marketing team just moved to a new office. What is the best first step?

- A. Change the sender name to include the new office’s city.
- B. Email the inactive contacts more often to wake them up.
- C. Remove the hard bounces, run a re-engagement campaign for the inactive contacts, and sunset those who stay silent.
- D. Keep every address, since a bigger list always means more revenue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which setup helps inbox providers verify that email really comes from the sender's domain?

- A. SPF, DKIM, and DMARC authentication records
- B. Sending from a no-reply address
- C. A mobile-responsive email template
- D. A double opt-in sign-up process

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A newsletter featuring the company's new mascot went to 12,500 addresses; 500 bounced. It drew 3,000 opens, 360 clicks, and 24 unsubscribes. What is the click-through rate based on delivered emails?

- A. 2.88%
- B. 3%
- C. 12%
- D. 25%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign was delivered to 8,000 contacts and had a 0.5% unsubscribe rate. How many people unsubscribed?

- A. 16,000
- B. 0.5
- C. 400
- D. 40

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A pet-supply store's list includes dog owners, cat owners, and aquarium hobbyists. It plans a promotion on premium dog food. The store's founder is a retired veterinarian. What is the best approach?

- A. Lead every email with the founder's veterinary background.
- B. Send it to the whole list to maximize reach.
- C. Include cat owners, since all pet owners buy dog food.
- D. Send it to the dog-owner segment with content personalized to their pets.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A software firm gets 600 ebook downloads a month, but only about 2% of those contacts are ready to buy. The office dog is popular on the company's social accounts. Which is a lead-nurture campaign?

- A. A series of helpful emails over several weeks, moving from tips to a case study to a demo invitation.
- B. Send one discount email and remove anyone who does not buy.
- C. Have sales call all 600 contacts the next day.
- D. Feature the office dog in a single welcome email.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A three-partner accounting firm wants to grow its email list of small-business owners before tax season. Which tactic is the strongest lead generator?

- A. Use a 20-field form, since more data is always better.
- B. Copy email addresses from local business websites.
- C. Offer a free tax-deadline checklist on a landing page with a short sign-up form.
- D. Add a small "subscribe" link to the website footer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A Miami-based travel company tests subject lines by sending Version A to 10% of its 100,000-person list and Version B to another 10%, then sending the winner to the rest. Version A also has a new hero image. Why is the test flawed?

- A. Samples of 10,000 each are too small.
- B. The Miami audience should be tested separately.
- C. Subject-line tests are always meaningless.
- D. Version A changes both the subject line and the image, so the cause of any difference is unclear.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Subject line A was delivered to 10,000 contacts and opened 2,200 times; B was delivered to 10,000 and opened 1,800 times. Which statement is correct?

- A.** A wins by 22 percentage points.
- B.** A wins by 4 percentage points (22% vs. 18%).
- C.** A wins by 400 points.
- D.** B wins, because fewer opens means fewer uninterested readers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An online shoe store sees many shoppers leave items in their carts. The store ships from a warehouse in Nevada. Which email automation fits best?

- A.** An abandoned-cart email triggered within hours, showing the items left behind.
- B.** Email every subscriber the same discount code every day.
- C.** Tell shoppers the store ships from Nevada.
- D.** Add cart abandoners to next month's newsletter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A fitness chain buys a list of 50,000 local email addresses from a data broker to promote a new gym. ~~The list cost \$2,000 and includes zip codes.~~ Under permission-based email practice, what is the core problem?

Target word: the core problem **Decides:** The contacts never gave the gym permission.

A	Camouflage	Price does not decide whether the list is usable.
B	Correct	Bought lists lack consent and drive complaints and spam-trap hits.
C	Absolute language	CAN-SPAM is opt-out based; the issue is best practice and reputation, and laws vary by country.
D	Dropped element	Drops the consent question; an opt-out does not create permission.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Under US CAN-SPAM, a subscriber clicks “unsubscribe” on a promotional email. How soon must the sender honor it?

Target word: opt-out deadline **Decides:** The CAN-SPAM rule.

A	Confusion set	A common guess, but longer than the law allows.
B	Adjacent category	Commercial messages to customers still must honor opt-outs.
C	Correct	CAN-SPAM requires opt-outs to be honored within 10 business days.
D	Absolute language	Fast is good practice, but that is not the legal rule.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A retailer’s list of 80,000 includes 9,000 addresses that hard-bounced last month and 20,000 with no opens in 18 months. Inbox placement is falling. ~~The marketing team just moved to a new office.~~ What is the best first step?

Target word: first hygiene step **Decides:** Hard bounces and long-inactive contacts damage reputation.

A	Camouflage	The move does not affect deliverability.
B	Inverted operation	More mail to unengaged contacts raises complaints and worsens placement.
C	Correct	Cleaning the list improves sender reputation and placement.
D	Absolute language	Dead addresses add risk, not revenue.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

Which setup helps inbox providers verify that email really comes from the sender’s domain?

Target word: reverse: from goal to tool **Decides:** Domain authentication.

A	Correct	These let receiving servers verify the sending domain.
B	Inverted operation	Discourages replies and does nothing to verify the domain.
C	Adjacent category	Improves reading, not authentication.
D	Confusion set	Confirms consent, not domain identity.

5. Answer B Concept 3

A newsletter featuring the company's new mascot went to 12,500 addresses; 500 bounced. It drew 3,000 opens, 360 clicks, and 24 unsubscribes. What is the click-through rate based on delivered emails?

Target word: CTR on delivered **Decides:** 360 / 12,000 delivered.

A	Dropped element	Uses 12,500 sent and drops the bounces.
B	Correct	Delivered = 12,000; 360 / 12,000 = 3%.
C	Confusion set	360 / 3,000 is click-to-open rate.
D	Adjacent category	3,000 / 12,000 is the open rate.

6. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A campaign was delivered to 8,000 contacts and had a 0.5% unsubscribe rate. How many people unsubscribed?

Target word: solve for count **Decides:** 8,000 × 0.005.

A	Inverted operation	Divides by 0.5 instead of multiplying by 0.005.
B	Wrong stem number	The rate, not the count.
C	Dropped element	Reads 0.5% as 5%, dropping a decimal place.
D	Correct	8,000 × 0.5% = 40.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A pet-supply store's list includes dog owners, cat owners, and aquarium hobbyists. It plans a promotion on premium dog food. ~~The store's founder is a retired veterinarian.~~ What is the best approach?

Target word: who gets the email **Decides:** The offer fits only dog owners.

A	Camouflage	A nice detail that does not decide who should receive the offer.
B	Dropped element	Drops segmentation; irrelevant mail drives unsubscribes.
C	Absolute language	A false generalization that sends irrelevant mail.
D	Correct	Relevant offers to the right segment lift engagement and cut unsubscribes.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A software firm gets 600 ebook downloads a month, but only about 2% of those contacts are ready to buy. ~~The office dog is popular on the company's social accounts.~~ Which is a lead-nurture campaign?

Target word: what nurturing looks like **Decides:** Most leads are not ready to buy yet.

A	Correct	Builds readiness over time before a sales hand-off.
B	Dropped element	Drops the sequence and gives up on 98% of leads.
C	Inverted operation	Skips nurturing and pushes unready leads to sales.
D	Camouflage	Answers the dog detail; it is not a nurture sequence.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A ~~three-partner~~ accounting firm wants to grow its email list of small-business owners before tax season. Which tactic is the strongest lead generator?

Target word: best lead-gen tactic **Decides:** A valuable offer exchanged for an email.

A	Absolute language	Long forms cut conversion; ask only what is needed.
B	Confusion set	Scraped addresses are not permission-based leads.
C	Correct	A relevant lead magnet gives people a reason to share their email.
D	Dropped element	Drops the value exchange that motivates sign-ups.

10. Answer D Concept 7

A ~~Miami-based~~ travel company tests subject lines by sending Version A to 10% of its 100,000-person list and Version B to another 10%, then sending the winner to the rest. Version A also has a new hero image. Why is the test flawed?

Target word: the flaw **Decides:** Two elements differ between the versions.

A	Wrong stem number	10,000 per version is a large sample.
B	Camouflage	Company location does not decide test validity.
C	Absolute language	They are useful when designed correctly.
D	Correct	Tests must vary one element at a time.

11. Answer B Concept 7 • transfer

Subject line A was delivered to 10,000 contacts and opened 2,200 times; B was delivered to 10,000 and opened 1,800 times. Which statement is correct?

Target word: interpret the result **Decides:** 22% vs. 18% open rates.

A	Confusion set	About 22% is the relative lift (4 / 18), not the point gap.
B	Correct	$2,200/10,000 = 22\%$; $1,800/10,000 = 18\%$.
C	Wrong stem number	The raw difference in opens, not a rate.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses the goal of the subject-line test.

12. Answer A Concept 8

An online shoe store sees many shoppers leave items in their carts. ~~The store ships from a warehouse in Nevada.~~ Which email automation fits best?

Target word: the right automation **Decides:** A specific action (cart left) should trigger a timely email.

A	Correct	Behavior-triggered and timely, while intent is high.
B	Dropped element	Drops the behavior trigger and wears out the list.
C	Camouflage	Answers the warehouse detail, not the abandoned carts.
D	Adjacent category	A batch send, too late and not tied to the action.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Permission and compliance	Email marketing best practice is permission-based; US CAN-SPAM also requires accurate headers, a physical address, and a working opt-out honored within 10 business days.	Using purchased lists, or thinking US law requires opt-in for every message.	A bought list or an unsubscribe request.
2	Deliverability and list hygiene	Sender reputation depends on low bounces and complaints and on authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC); remove hard bounces and sunset long-inactive contacts.	Mailing unengaged contacts more often to “wake them up.”	Falling inbox placement with many bounces or inactive addresses.
3	Email metrics math	Delivered = sent – bounces; open rate, click-through rate, and unsubscribe rate use delivered as the base; click-to-open = clicks / opens.	Using sent as the base, or mixing CTR with click-to-open.	Sent, bounced, opened, clicked, and unsubscribed listed together.
4	Segmentation	Send each message only to the segment whose interests or behavior make it relevant.	Blasting every offer to the whole list.	A list with clearly different groups and an offer that fits one.
5	Lead nurturing	A nurture campaign sends a planned sequence of helpful emails over time, moving leads toward readiness before a sales hand-off.	Having sales call every new lead at once, or sending one email and giving up.	Many new leads, few ready to buy.
6	Lead generation with a lead magnet	Offer something valuable (guide, checklist, tool) on a focused landing page in exchange for an email address.	Relying on a bare “subscribe” link or collecting too much data up front.	“Grow the list” with a specific audience in mind.
7	A/B testing emails	Test one variable at a time on comparable samples, then send the winner; judge by the metric that variable affects.	Changing two things at once, or confusing percentage points with percent lift.	Two versions with open or click results.
8	Behavior-triggered automation	Triggered emails (welcome, abandoned cart, post-purchase) fire automatically when a contact takes an action.	Folding behavior-based messages into a scheduled batch newsletter.	A specific customer action that should prompt a timely email.

Course scope (public description): Email Marketing examines the principles and techniques used to effectively manage email marketing campaigns. Email is used daily in both personal and business settings to communicate with others. In this course, learners will examine industry best practices of how to use email marketing as a digital strategy to achieve marketing goals. Learners will explore how to design an email marketing strategy, how to use email marketing for lead generation, how to design a lead nurture campaign, and how automation is used to manage email marketing distribution and campaigns. This course provides learners with an opportunity to explore how effective email messages are crafted and distributed. Industry best practices will be explored and learners have the opportunity to complete the HubSpot Email Marketing certification to enhance marketability within the marketing profession.